

32~33 다음 글을 읽고, 물음에 답하십시오.

For a great illustration of the perils of expert decision making when faced with innovation, consider Richard Wagner's *Die Meistersinger von Nürnberg*. This fabulous comic opera revolves around the Meistersingers, a guild of amateur poets and musicians who are master craftsmen in their main professions. The Meistersingers have developed a craftsmanlike approach to music making, with an intricate system of rules for composing and performing songs. They use these rules to make important decisions: whether a song is a master song and whether the singer qualifies as a Meistersinger. The group resists input from anybody else. When a new contestant, the knight Walther von Stolzing, delivers a novel free-form tune, breaking all the rules of the craft, they cannot _____ his innovativeness. However, after some maneuvering behind the scenes, and five hours into the opera, Walther wins the singing contest. Interestingly, as with so many creative ideas, Walther's prize song came to him in a dream.

The opera is also about Wagner, the innovator, and the difficulties he had as a composer. The "Meistersinger syndrome," however, is not just a historical phenomenon. Sadly, I have seen corporate boards and committees that act just like Meistersingers. They insist on absurd small rules and criteria. They are narrow-minded groups that define rules and criteria based on how they have always done business. They are subject to groupthink because they do not seek outside input and do not vote on ideas independently. Bold ideas will not have a chance with them even if there is a clear business case for these ideas.

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